

THE DS GROUP WALKING THE TALK



Rajiv Kumar
Vice Chairman, DS Group

Leading the way to a greener future

The DS Group is a shining example of an Indian organization that is committed to a sustainable ecosystem, and makes a significant contribution to the world through its environmental initiatives.

The environment is everyone's responsibility.

We have all learned this the hard way. Climate change and the state of the very basics of our lives — air, water and soil — have been threatened by decades of thoughtless consumption.

Currently, roughly half of worlds ~8 billion people are estimated to experience severe water scarcity for at least some part of the year due to climatic and non-climatic factors. During the last two decades, the global glacier mass loss rate exceeded 0.5 meters water equivalent per year, impacting humans and ecosystems. Agriculture and energy production have been impacted by changes in the hydrological cycle. Between 1983 and 2009, approximately three-quarters of the global harvested areas experienced yield losses induced by drought, with the cumulative production losses corresponding to USD 166 billion. (Source: IPCC_AR6_WGII)

The impact is being experienced on a global, planetary scale, and directly within our homes and communities. A thriving and healthy environment is a non-negotiable imperative and it is critical today to work towards sustainability and environmental well-being to nurture a happy society, a successful country, and a balanced world. All our achievements can only be meaningful when we create a renewable and supportive environmental, economic and social world. Many nations and governments are working within their countries towards this goal, and there has been a clarion call worldwide to come together for earth-first.

The Group's Vice Chairman Mr. Rajiv Kumar stated, *"In the pursuit of improved prospects for the future generations and safeguard our resources, we work to balance environmental, societal and economic considerations. Our sustainability initiatives are spread across the country and in area of energy management, water management, material conservation, recycling and waste management. This aligns our business, social and environmental objectives to make significant contribution to the society and the country. This fulfils our ethos of responsible growth, while delivering superior value to all our stakeholders".*

The DS Group has, very early on, recognized the huge potential that corporates and organizations hold to influence and transform the environment within their reach. The Group has led the way with intent and action.

A multi-business corporation, the DS Group is one of the leading FMCG conglomerate with a strong Indian and international presence. Founded in the year 1929, it is an inspiring and successful business story that blends a remarkable history and legacy with visionary growth. Guided by a clear set of values and built on a strong foundation of philanthropy, corporate responsibility is an integral part of the Group's business objectives to enhance livelihoods and build sustainable communities.

Water Conservation

Water is at the core of the sustainable well-being of humankind, serving crucial links between society, economics, and the environment. Realizing the vitality of water resources, the DS Group has been diligently undertaking cross-sectoral Integrated Water Conservation and Management projects, through its CSR activities in 6 states, benefitting millions of people from impoverished communities. The Group has developed more than 900 water-harvesting structures, with the cumulative capacity of around 80 lakh cubic meters covering 2300 hectares of area under irrigation. Consequently, the crop productivity in the respective areas have increased many-fold.